

A DATA-DRIVEN ANALYSIS

Beyond the Rankings

Why Europe's Crime Data Tells a Different Story

PRESENTED BY

Victoria Antai Bassey
Student Number: 948253
v.bassey@campus.unimib.it

Based on Eurostat Crime Statistics • 2014–2023

CRIME + SAFETY



27 EU NATIONS

TRENDS



10 YEARS

GEOGRAPHY



CROSS-BORDER

The Questions That Matter

- 01 Do crime rankings actually reflect real risk — or just population size?
- 02 What happens when we look at trends over time instead of snapshots?
- 03 Can profiling countries reveal more than simply ranking them?

About the Data

DATA FOUNDATION



DATA SOURCE

Data sourced from Eurostat — the official EU statistics database.



COVERAGE

- Covers crime counts across European countries, Includes data from 2014 to 2023.
- Population data from Eurostat.



DATA PREPARATION

- Combined with population data for fair comparison.
- Based on police-recorded offences.



DATA LICENCE

Eurostat data is published under the European Commission's open data policy and is freely available for reuse with attribution. This allows the data to be used for analysis, visualisation, and academic research.

The Game Plan

METHODOLOGY



DATA PREPARATION

- Cleaned and structured data for consistency across countries
- Standardized crime metrics for comparison



ANALYTICAL APPROACH

- Compared raw crime totals vs per capita rates
- Analyzed trends over time (2014–2023)
- Grouped countries based on risk level and trend direction



VISUALISATION

- Analysis and visualizations created with Python, pandas, Matplotlib and Flourish.
- Background visuals on slide 1 was created using CANVA AI.

Insights from the Data

KEY FINDINGS



STATISTICAL HIGHLIGHTS

- **Max raw crime (2023):** France — ~1.5M offences
- **Min raw crime (2023):** Cyprus — ~1,069 offences
- **Highest per capita rate:** Luxembourg — ~4,000 per 100K
- **Biggest increase (2014-2023):** Austria — +74.4%
- **Biggest decline:** Malta — -66.7%



ANALYSIS OPERATIONS

- **Ranking comparison:** Raw totals vs per capita rates to expose population bias
- **Trend analysis:** % change in crime rates from 2014 to 2023 across all 27 EU nations
- **Quadrant profiling:** Grouped countries by risk level × trend direction into 4 profiles



KEY TAKEAWAY

Rankings based on raw crime counts are misleading. Population adjustment and trend analysis reveal that smaller nations like Luxembourg carry higher per-person risk, while large countries like France and Germany are not necessarily the most dangerous per capita. Austria recorded the sharpest increase (+74.4%), while Malta recorded the biggest decline (-66.7%).

The Data Has Blind Spots



Hidden Crime

Official statistics only capture reported incidents. The true level of crime is likely higher, as many go unreported.



Reporting Gaps

Trust in police, cultural norms, and awareness levels vary widely — meaning some countries report far more than others.



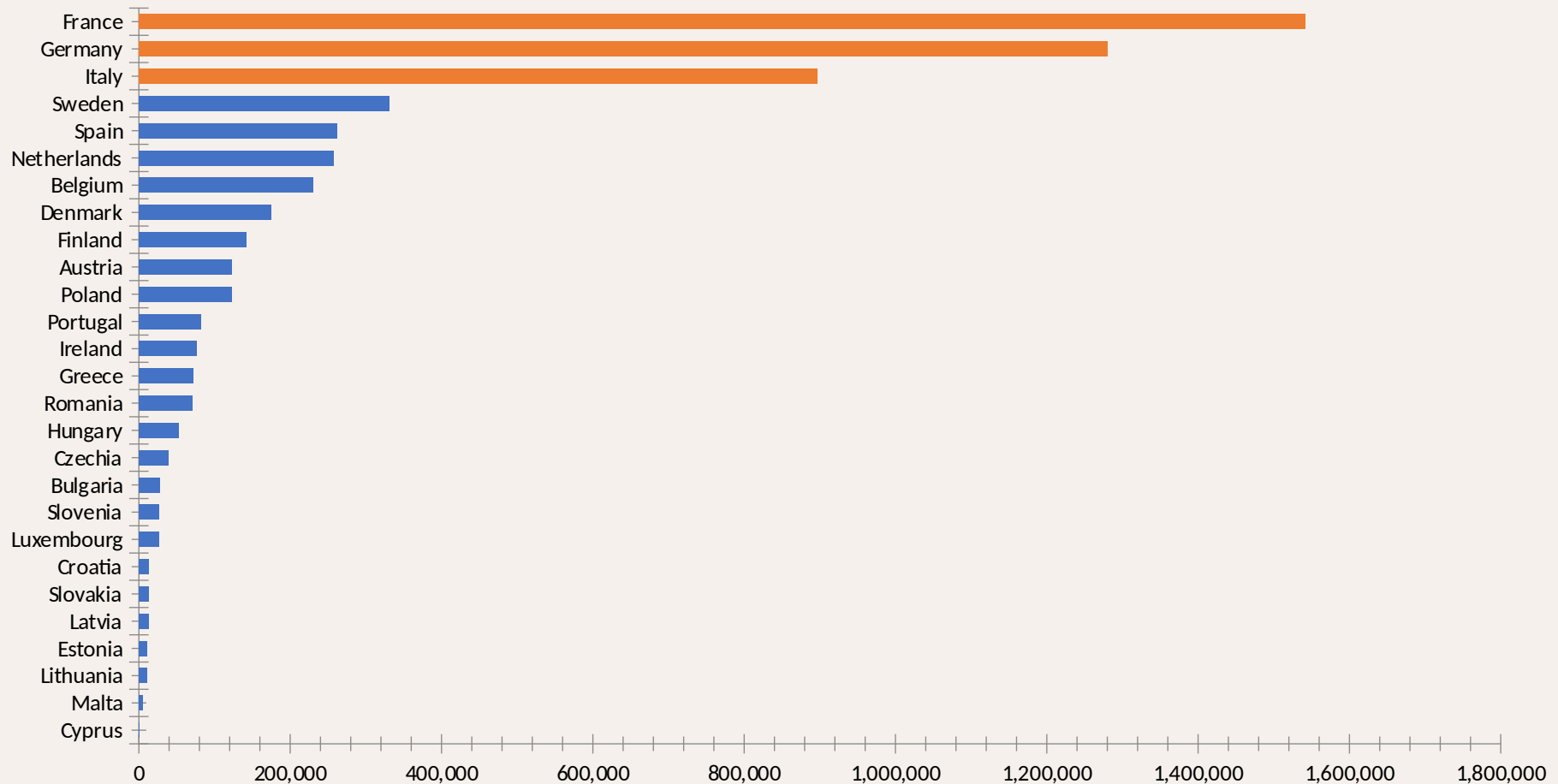
Different Rules

Legal definitions of crime differ across borders. The same act may be classified differently from country to country.

The Ranking Illusion

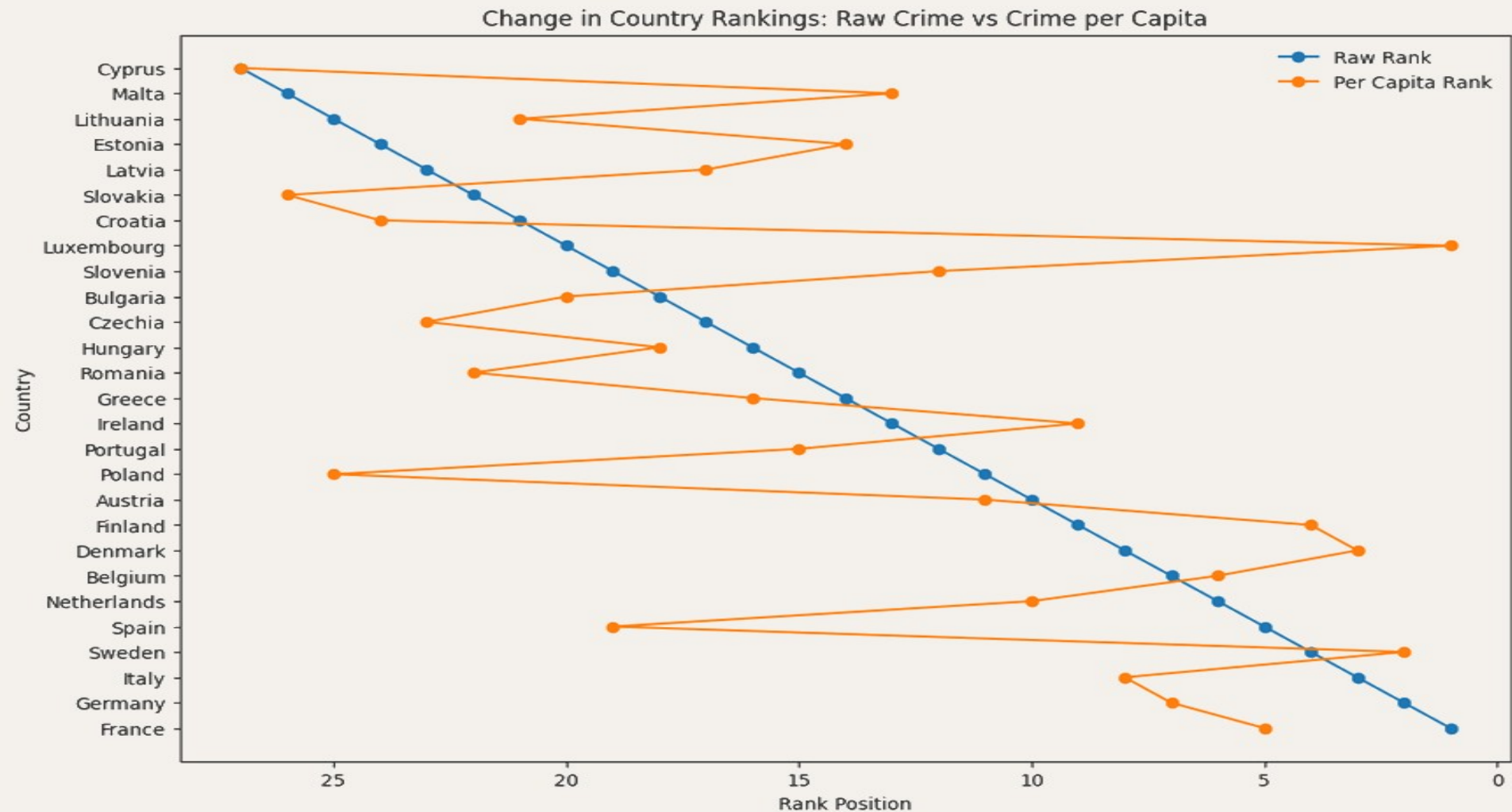
France, Germany, and Italy top the chart, but this ranking reflects population size, not risk. In raw counts, larger countries appear more dangerous, masking the true per-person exposure.

EU Countries Ranked by Raw Crime Value (2023)



The Population Effect

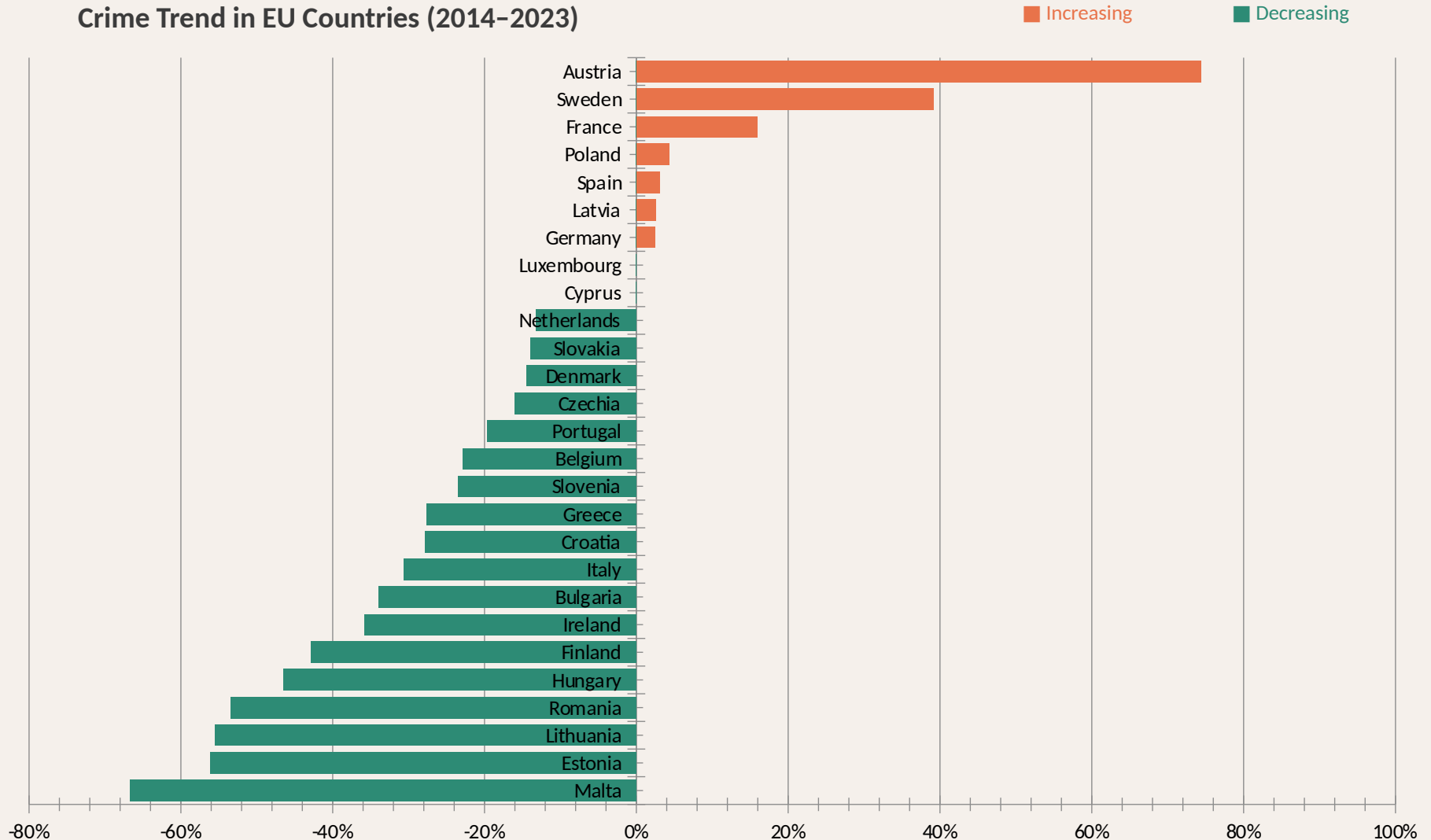
Raw crime counts make large countries look the most dangerous, but this is a statistical illusion. Once adjusted for population, the picture flips: France, Germany, and Italy fall back, while smaller nations like Luxembourg and Finland emerge with higher per-person risk.



The Trend Factor

Crime patterns evolve over time. Over the past decade, Malta and Estonia have recorded the steepest declines, while Austria and Sweden have seen the sharpest upward trends.

Crime Trend in EU Countries (2014–2023)



Beyond the Rankings

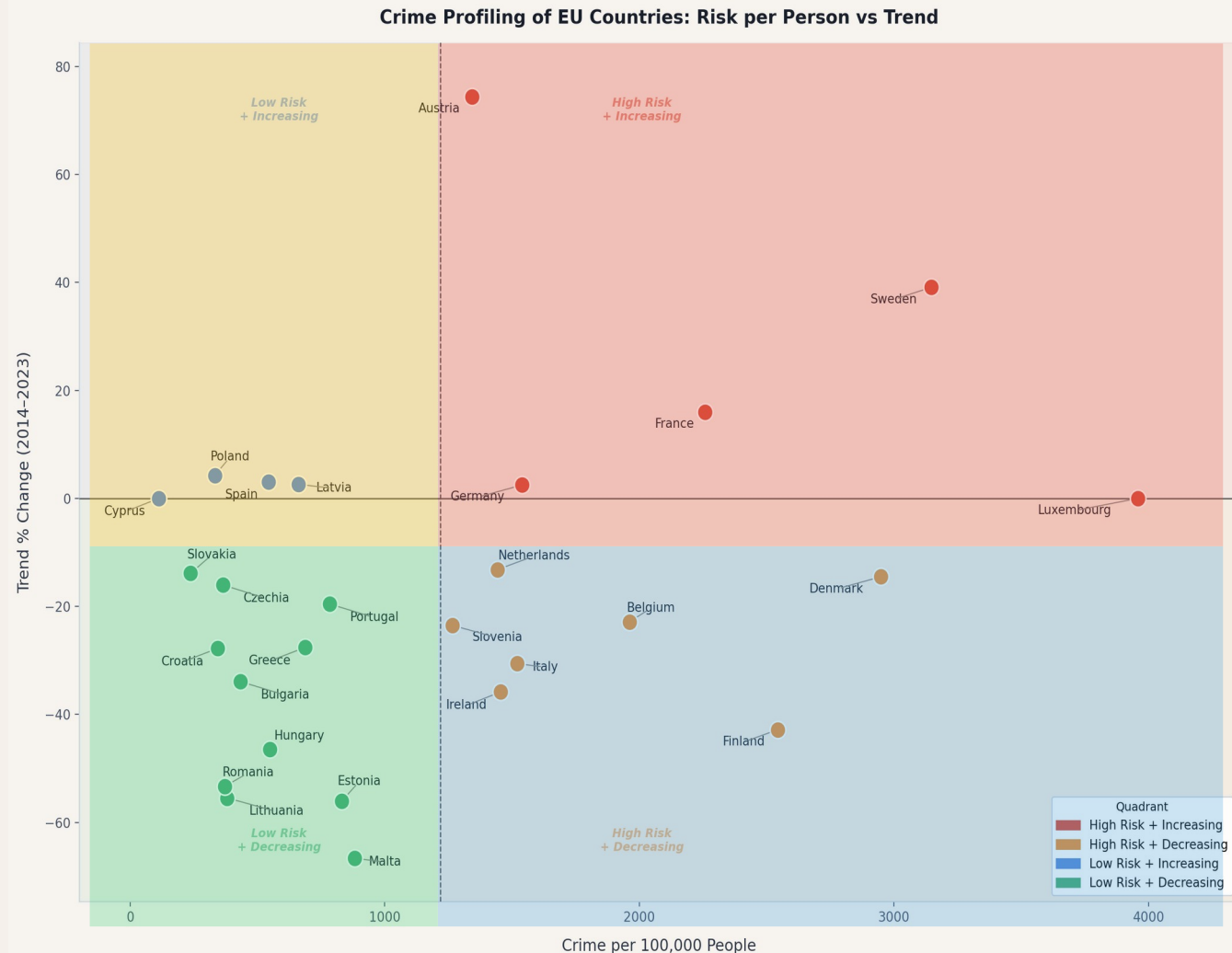
Where risk meets momentum — four profiles that tell a deeper story than any league table

Crime Profiling of EU Countries: Risk per Person vs Trend

Instead of asking which country is worst, this approach asks a better question: "where is risk high", and is it getting better or worse? That gives us a much clearer understanding of safety across countries.

Countries are grouped into four profiles:

- **High Risk + Increasing** — high crime rates that are still growing (e.g. Luxembourg, France)
- **High Risk + Decreasing** — high crime rates but trending downward (e.g. Denmark, Italy)
- **Low Risk + Increasing** — lower crime rates but on the rise (e.g. Latvia, Spain)
- **Low Risk + Decreasing** — lower crime rates and improving further (e.g. Poland, Romania)



What the Data Really Shows

01 Rankings Oversimplify
Raw crime counts favor larger nations and hide the real story.

02 Population Reshapes the Picture
Per capita data reveals that smaller countries often carry higher individual risk.

03 Trends Show Direction
A country's crime rate matters less than whether it's rising or falling.

04 Profiling Reveals the Truth
Combining risk level with trend direction creates a far clearer safety picture.

The real question isn't which country is most dangerous — it's how we choose to measure danger.

Rankings simplify. Profiling illuminates. The data tells a richer story when we ask better questions.

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SOURCES & TOOLS

Data Source

Eurostat – Crime Statistics (2014–2023)
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Charts & Visualizations

Analysis and visualizations created with Python, pandas, Matplotlib and Flourish

Backgrounds & Design

Background visuals on Slide 1 was created using CANVA AI, used under CANVA's content license for non- commercial and educational purposes

This project is fully reproducible. All data, code, and visualizations are available on [GitHub](#)